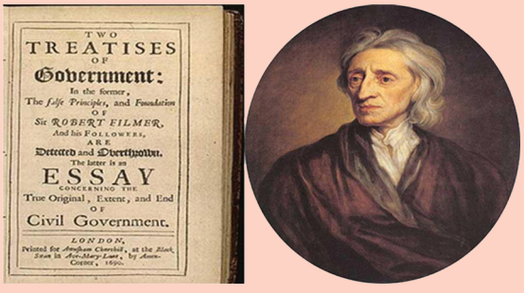
known as 'Libertarianism' is followed by major countries of the world for the last four decades.

A. Negative liberalism

Negative Liberalism is also known by many names like 'Laissez Faire' Liberalism and Classical Liberalism. John Locke in his book 'Two Treaties of Civil Government' propounded the basic political principles of Negative Liberalism that came to be implemented vigorously in the USA.



John Locke, Father of Classical liberalism. The Equal Right to Life, Liberty, and Property.

Thomas Paine, Montesquieu, Jeremy Bentham are the other important proponents of Negative Liberalism. Economically, Adam Smith advocated Negative Liberalism in his book 'An Inquiry into the Nature and Causes of Wealth of Nations'

Essence of Negative Liberalism

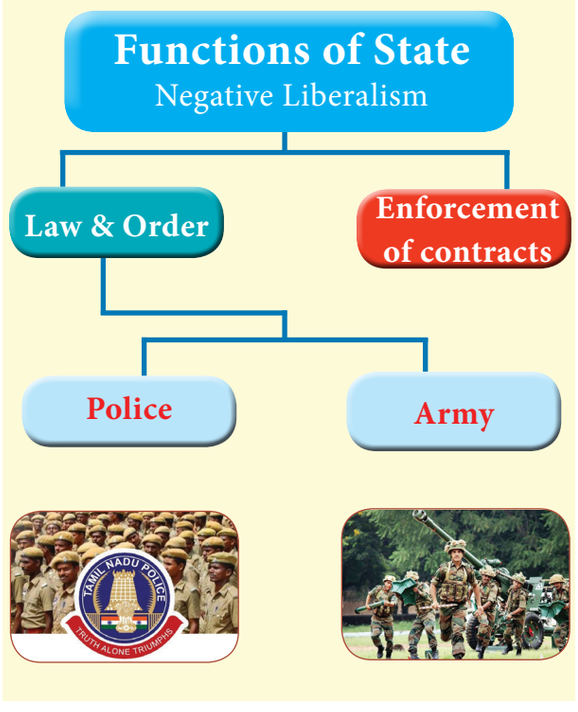
Negative Liberalism considers man as a rational, capable and masterless individual. All human beings are equal and free. Everyone knows their interests and is endowed with the capacity to satisfy their interests. Society is a mere aggregate of freely existing individuals. There is no necessity for State and society to interfere or regulate the life of individuals.

The State is a necessary evil. It is necessary for the protection of law and order without which individuals cannot realise their interests. Nevertheless, the State is an evil as even its mere existence itself endangers the rights and liberties of the individuals.

The State is a negative State as it is prohibited from carrying out developmental activities. The State is called as Laissez Faire State. Laissez Faire has its origin in the French language meaning 'Leave Alone'. The State must leave the individuals alone to pursue their activities. Maintenance of law and order and enforcement of legally made contracts are the only functions assigned to the State by Negative Liberalism.

ACTIVITY

Where does India stand in the concept of liberalism after 1991 economic reforms?



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